



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

seveta-imāṃs tu niyamān brahmacārī gurau vasan | 2.175a
sanniyamya-indriyagrāmaṃ tapovṛddhi.artham ātmanaḥ || 175 || 2.175c
nityaṃ snātvā śuciḥ kuryād deva.rṣi.pitṛtarpaṇam | 2.176a
devatābhycanam ca-eva samidādhānam eva ca || 176 || 2.176c

— Manusmṛti, 2.2.10. Observances (Chapter 10), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The student, while dwelling with the guru, should diligently practice these observances. This verse from the Manusmṛti speaks to the heart of spiritual growth, emphasizing the importance of disciplined living for the dedicated seeker. It highlights the need to restrain the senses, a practice essential for increasing inner strength and spiritual wisdom. You are encouraged to cultivate self-control, not as a form of harsh denial, but as a means of focusing your energy and attention on the path of self-discovery.

The text further instructs on daily purification through bathing, followed by offering oblations to the gods, sages, and ancestors. This isn't merely about ritualistic actions; it's about acknowledging the interconnectedness of all beings and expressing gratitude for the wisdom and lineage that has paved the way for your spiritual journey. The act of offering respects to the deities represents a connection to the divine principles that govern the universe, while honoring the sages recognizes the value of knowledge and guidance. Remembering your ancestors acknowledges your roots and the karmic heritage you carry.

Furthermore, the verse mentions the importance of worshipping deities and offering clarified butter into the sacred fire. This signifies the sublimation of your ego and desires into the divine flame of transformation. In modern life, this can be translated as dedicating your actions to a higher purpose, offering your talents and resources to serve others, and constantly striving to purify your thoughts and intentions. By integrating these practices into your daily routine, you cultivate a sense of inner peace, clarity, and purpose. Though you may not live in an ashram, the spirit of disciplined practice, gratitude, and selfless service can be incorporated into any lifestyle. The essence is to live consciously, with intention, and with a deep awareness of your connection to something larger than yourself.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you integrate the principles of self-discipline and gratitude into your daily routine to foster inner peace and spiritual growth, even amidst the demands of modern life?